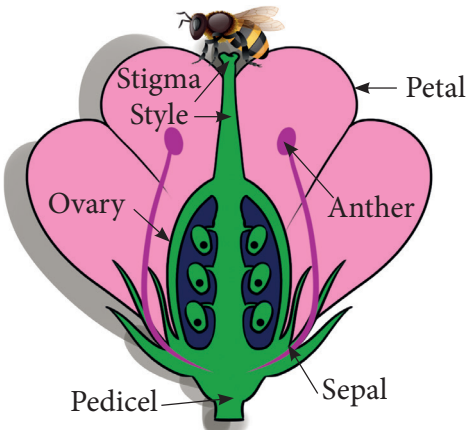
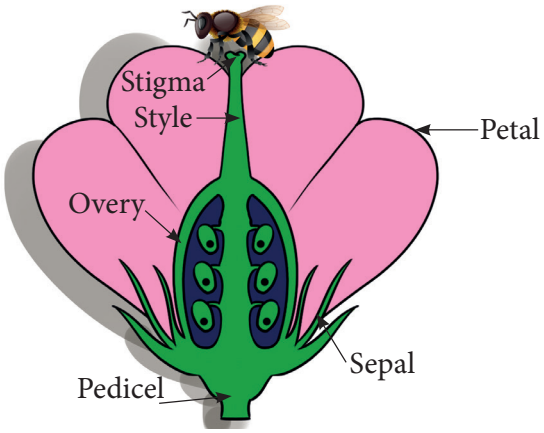
ACTIVITY 5

Using the information from the above diagram complete the following table:

Name of the flower	Complete / Incomplete	Unisexual / Bisexual	Male / Female
Hibiscus			
Pumpkin			
Rose			
Coconut			
Jasmine			



Bisexual Flower



Unisexual Flower

5.2.3 Pollination

We know that flowers of pumpkin are unisexual - that is some flowers are male while many are female flowers. We can easily identify the male and female flower of pumpkin, even before the buds bloom. To understand how a flower develops into fruit, let us perform an experiment on pumpkin plant.

ACTIVITY 6

Once flower buds appear, immediately identify ten female flower buds from a pumpkin plant. Tie a plastic bag around each bud so that no outside material can enter inside. Ensure to make small holes with a pin to allow air flow. Wait for two to three days to bloom.



Female



Male

Choose three to four male flowers. Pluck the stamens of these flowers and dust the pollen grains in a sheet of paper and collect it. Open five out of ten bags containing female flowers. Brush the collected pollen grains on the stigma with a soft paint brush. Take care not to damage the stigma. After few days we can see that flower in all bags that were not opened at all would wilt without forming a fruit, while most of the flowers to which pollens have been applied bear fruits.